COMPLAINT COMPASS · WHEN THEY ASK "HOW WILL YOU SCALE THIS?"

Scalability: say it like you're thinking out loud

About 70 seconds. Don't read it word for word; the prompts below are enough.

"Let me start with how big this is. In India, quick-commerce apps get about **seven point eight million orders every day**. Some of those go wrong, and people complain.

We can see part of it in government data. The national consumer helpline gets about **five thousand calls a day**. In one year, **Swiggy had about ninety-five hundred complaints** there, and **Zomato about seven thousand**. And it's the same few problems again and again: **refunds that never came, late deliveries, damaged items, payments that failed.** Those are **exactly the problems our system catches early.**

And that's only what reaches the government. Most people just complain to the app directly. We estimate **eighty thousand to two lakh complaints a day** in quick commerce. That sounds huge, but it's **only one to three complaints a second.**

So can we handle it? Yes. **Reading a complaint is the slow part, and it doesn't share anything, so we just add more workers.** One worker reads about **fifteen complaints a second**.

Take **Swiggy's Instamart**. It has about a quarter of the market, so roughly **two million orders a day**. If two in every hundred lead to a complaint, that's about **forty thousand complaints a day**, which is **less than one a second**. Even at busy times, say five times that, **one reading worker is enough**. So **Instamart runs on two servers**, and one of those is just a backup. The AI bill is about **fifty dollars a month**.

Saving the complaint under the right issue is the only tricky part, because two workers could create the same issue twice. So **each area, like payments or delivery, gets its own single worker**, and all the areas work at the same time. **A new company just adds new areas. If one area gets too busy, we split it.**

And it stays cheap. **Most complaints never need the expensive AI**, so at ten million complaints a month we pay **about four hundred dollars**.

It's not built at that size yet, so **the first thing we'll do is a load test.**"

Or remember six prompts and talk

1. **How big:** 7.8M quick-commerce orders a day.
2. **Government data:** helpline ~5,000 calls a day; Swiggy ~9,500, Zomato ~7,000 a year. Same problems: refunds, late delivery, damaged items, failed payments; exactly what we catch early.
3. **Real volume:** most complain to the app directly; 80,000 to 2 lakh a day = only 1–3 a second.
4. **Reading:** shares nothing, so add workers; ~15 a second each.
5. **Swiggy Instamart:** ~2M orders a day → ~40,000 complaints → under 1 a second → 2 servers (1 backup), ~$50 a month.
6. **Saving:** one worker per area so no duplicates; new company = new areas; busy area = split.
7. **Cost and honesty:** ~$400 a month at 10M complaints; not built at that size yet, load test first.

Only if they ask for detail

Swiggy Instamart, worked out

Step	Calculation	Result
Orders a day	25% market share × 7.8M orders	~1.95M
Complaints a day	2% of orders (our assumption)	~39,000 (0.45 a second)
Busy-hour peak	5× average (our assumption)	~2.3 a second
Reading workers	2.3 ÷ 15 per worker	1 (plus a backup)
Saving workers	7 areas × ~3.5 a second each = ~24	7, well under capacity
Servers	All workers and the database fit on one	2 (one is a backup)
Model cost	~1.17M complaints a month × $4.33 per 100,000	~$51 a month

Market share: GAEE India report, 2025 (Instamart 25%). Order volume: RedSeer via GAEE. Food-delivery orders not included (no verified figure).

Escalated to the government, FY24	Per year	Per day
Flipkart	1,60,857	~440
Amazon	58,875	~160
Swiggy	9,527	~26
Zomato	6,983	~19
Blinkit	1,244	~3
All e-commerce	4,45,960	~1,200
RBI Ombudsman (FY25, banking)	13.34 lakh	~3,650

Volume a month	Workers	Partitions	Model cost
1M (one business)	2	7	$43
10M (~10 businesses)	2–4	~70	$433
100M (~100 businesses)	13–16	~700	$4,330

Throughput projected from latencies measured on the live run; model cost = $4.33 per 100,000 (measured) × volume, hosting excluded.

Sources: Storyboard18 citing the Consumer Affairs Ministry's FY24 data (company figures); Storyboard18, 21 May 2025 (complaint types: deficient service, refunds not processed, cancellation charges); PIB, 14 Mar 2025 (1,55,138 helpline calls in Dec 2024); The Tribune/ANI (RBI); GAEE report citing RedSeer (7.8M orders a day, Jan 2026). "80,000 to 2 lakh a day" is our estimate assuming 1–3% of orders lead to a complaint. Don't quote unverified 2025 company figures (e.g. Zepto 5,774).